

HSC BUSINESS STUDIES

Human Resources — exam focus

Short-answer practice on the points you flagged

27 short-answer questions across 5 syllabus points in four topics

Drawn from NESA HSC 2019–2023, school trial papers 2023–24, and topic question banks.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOKLET

- Short answer only — no multiple choice, and no 20-mark extended responses.
- Ruled space follows each question, sized to its mark value.
- A question testing two of these points is printed once and cross-referenced from the other.

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TOPIC

Human Resources

Strategic role of human resource management

1. 24 (a) Roseville Trial 2023

2 marks

Outline the strategic role of human resource management.

2. 24 (a) Abbotsleigh Trial 2023

2 marks

Outline the strategic role of the human resource function.

Outsourcing

3. 24 (a) Roseville Trial 2024

1 mark

Identify one human resource function that Green Earth Ltd could outsource.

STIMULUS

Green Earth Ltd is a mid-sized manufacturing company that produces eco-friendly household products. Due to rapid growth and an increase in customer demand, the company's management team is considering outsourcing certain human resource functions to improve efficiency and focus on core activities.

4. 24 (a) Barker Trial 2024

2 marks

Outline ONE disadvantage of outsourcing human resources functions.

5. 24 (b) Roseville Trial 2023

2 marks

Describe ONE benefit that might result from deciding to outsource an aspect of human resource management.

6. 23 (b) 2021 HSC Business Studies

2 marks

Why might a business use a contractor to recruit staff?

7. 24 (b) Barker Trial 2023

3 marks

Why would a business outsource their human resource functions?

8. 24 (b) Roseville Trial 2024

4 marks

Describe two benefits this company might experience from outsourcing this human resource function.

STIMULUS

Green Earth Ltd is a mid-sized manufacturing company that produces eco-friendly household products. Due to rapid growth and an increase in customer demand, the company's management team is considering outsourcing certain human resource functions to improve efficiency and focus on core activities.

9. Question 22 (a) HSC Final Exam Preparation — HRM

4 marks

Outline TWO benefits of outsourcing key human resource functions for this business.

STIMULUS

A manufacturing business operating across Australia employs a large workforce. Management decides to outsource key human resource functions including recruitment, induction, change management, training and development of employees. Recently there has been an industrial dispute with employees demanding higher pay, and better working conditions.

Processes of human resource management

10. 22 (d) 2022 HSC Business Studies

3 marks

Explain the importance of carrying out an induction program for new employees.

11. 24 (c) Loreto Trial 2024

4 marks

Analyse the impact of technological influences on ONE of the human resource processes at TechWorld.

STIMULUS

TechWorld is reviewing its human resources strategies to ensure alignment with its goals for: growth; innovation; supportive work culture; current legal framework.

12. 23 (c) Reddam Trial 2024

4 marks

Explain how a business can use TWO human resources management processes to achieve a competitive advantage.

13. 21 (b) 2020 HSC Business Studies

4 marks

Distinguish between voluntary and involuntary separation.

14. 21 (c) 2020 HSC Business Studies

4 marks

Explain how technological influences and globalisation can lead to a company reducing staff numbers.
Support your answer with relevant examples.

15. 22 (c) SIC Trial 2024

5 marks

Describe how changes in technology impact on Human Resources processes.

16. 21 (c) Newington Trial 2023

5 marks

Discuss the strategy of internal recruitment for Raj.

STIMULUS

Raj owns a business that designs security software. His business is rapidly expanding due to the increase in companies allowing their employees to work from home. Raj needs to increase his workforce to keep up with his demand. The work is complicated and requires excellent knowledge of coding and software design. Due to the expansion, Raj requires more employees in management roles.

Leadership style

17. 21 (a) Newington Trial 2023

2 marks

Identify TWO ways that leadership style can affect employee performance in a business.

18. 23 (b) Knox Trial 2023

6 marks

Justify the use of rewards and leadership style as strategies to improve the effectiveness of human resource management for this business.

STIMULUS

HiFashion is a fast fashion retail store with 40 stores around Australia employing 200 staff. Management is concerned about a reduction in productivity and staff feedback; staff cited rewards, leadership style and dispute resolution methods as key to their dissatisfaction. Data extract: staff turnover 10% (2021) to 20% (2022); employee satisfaction 80% (2021) to 65% (2022); number of disputes 10 per year (2021) to 25 per year (2022).

Indicators

19. 24 (a) Barker Trial 2023

2 marks

Define corporate culture.

20. 23 (a) Reddam Trial 2023

2 marks

Outline ONE indicator that can be used to measure the effectiveness of human resource management in a business.

21. 23 (a) 2021 HSC Business Studies

2 marks

Outline how corporate culture can affect staff turnover.

22. 24 (b) Barker Trial 2024

3 marks

Why is corporate culture an indicator of the effectiveness of human resource management?

23. 24 (c) Independent Trial 2024

4 marks

Explain how TWO indicators can be used to evaluate the effectiveness of the human resource function.

24. 22 (d) Abbotsleigh Trial 2024

4 marks

Recommend TWO indicators that could be used by Spend More to measure the effectiveness of its human resource management.

STIMULUS

The retail business, Spend More, has been rapidly expanding in the past 2 years and requires additional staff and premises. However, the increasing changes have led to conflict and uncertainty between management and employees in the workplace.

25. 24 (b) Loreto Trial 2024

4 marks

Recommend TWO indicators that could be used by TechWorld to measure the effectiveness of its human resource management.

STIMULUS

TechWorld is reviewing its human resources strategies to ensure alignment with its goals for: growth; innovation; supportive work culture; current legal framework.

26. 24 (b) Abbotsleigh Trial 2023

4 marks

To what extent is human resources management effective in this business? Support your answer with examples from the data.

STIMULUS

Table of data for a business, 2021 vs 2022. Human Resources costs: \$2 600 000 (2021) vs \$2 000 000 (2022). Training expenditure per employee: \$1900 vs \$1500. Absenteeism per employee: 10 days vs 14 days. Accidents per 1000 employees: 50 vs 30. Number of strike days: 2 vs 10. Staff turnover: 15% vs 10%.

27. **24 (c)** Barker Trial 2023 · Barker Trial 2024

5 marks

Evaluate the effectiveness of human resources management at this business.

STIMULUS

Table of data for a business between 2022 and 2023: Absenteeism per employee 10 days (2022) rising to 15 days (2023); Staff turnover 15% rising to 18%; Training expenditure per employee \$2 100 rising to \$3 400; Accidents per 100 employees falling from 11 to 5.

Also tested by question 18.